

FROM BECOMING PM"



Photographs by MANEESH AGNIHOTRI

Q. So you will attempt to break parties.

A. I am against breaking any party, but those who come on their own are welcome.

Q. But you will still need the support of the Congress or the BJP to become the prime minister. Going by the political arithmetic, the Dalit ki beti will still need the Congress or the BJP support to become prime minister.

A. Lok Sabha elections are just a few months away, and I am sure that the BJP and company and Congress and its allies will not get more than 200 seats. So the rest account for 340. I will not need support from either of them for majority.

Q. What is the reason for the current rise in terrorism—minority appeasement, weak government, or lack of a strong law?

A. We should not link terrorism to politics. The state and the Central governments should sit together and strategise ways to contain it. Yes, our borders are weak which helps terrorists. They don't come with a visa, they come from the borders, illegally. So it is up to the Central Government to check infiltration along the borders and for the state governments to make tough

“My party is not against privatisation but when state units are privatised, the reservation rights of the Scheduled Castes should be protected.”

allegations are the ones who are indulging in caste-based politics.

Q. Do you think they are trying to undermine you since you are now the UNPA leader and a serious contender for prime ministership?

A. I am the leader of BSP. UNPA is different, Left is separate. They all have their own regional leaders.

Q. But the UNPA leaders are promoting you as the prime minister.

A. I welcome this suggestion and I am grateful to them.

Q. Samajwadi Party leader Mulayam Singh Yadav was their first choice. And like him, one day they may ditch you too.

A. The UNPA leaders did first go to Mulayam. And like you said, they may leave me too. But there are many coalition partners in the UPa and the NDA who are attracted to the BSP. And there will be a time when they will also join us.

anti-terror laws.

Q. Tough laws like POTA?

A. Not necessarily like POTA, but strong laws.

Q. Should Afzal Guru be hanged?

A. It is up to the Government to take a decision on this issue. I don't want to say anything on this. When I become prime minister, there will be no terrorist incidents.

Q. The terrorists will feel scared of you and not come out at all?

A. (Laughs)

Q. People say you are a dictator.

A. No, I believe in democracy and take everyone's views into account.

Q. How did a Dalit ki beti amass such massive fortune and own so many houses?

A. The CBI has filed an affidavit in the court which is false. When my lawyer presents my case, the truth will come out.